

4. Project Planning Phase

Implementation schedule, milestones, and risk planning

Work Plan

Complete the project in the order of spreadsheet preparation, table setup, Import Set creation, Transform Map configuration, transformation, Coalesce testing, report creation, dashboard assembly, and final documentation.

Milestones

- M1 — Spreadsheet prepared and saved as .xlsx.
- M2 — Employee Test custom table and fields created.
- M3 — Employee Import staging table created and spreadsheet loaded.
- M4 — Transform Map saved with verified field mappings.
- M5 — First transformation completed and target data checked.
- M6 — Coalesce enabled and repeat-import behavior tested.
- M7 — Reports created and added to dashboard.
- M8 — Screenshots, report, and demonstration materials completed.

Suggested Task Allocation

- Data preparation: create the spreadsheet and check headers and sample values.
- Platform configuration: create the target table, staging table, and Transform Map.
- Testing: run imports, verify records, and check duplicate/update behavior.
- Presentation: capture screenshots, document results, and prepare the demonstration.

Risk Analysis

- Incorrect or inconsistent spreadsheet headers may prevent expected field mapping; review headers before loading.
- Wrong source-to-target mapping may place values in incorrect fields; inspect every field map before transforming.
- Duplicate records may result if Coalesce is not configured or uses an unsuitable key; test with controlled sample IDs.
- Insufficient ServiceNow permissions may block table, transform, report, or dashboard creation; confirm roles early.
- UI differences across releases may alter navigation; use the relevant module search and verify equivalent form options.

Deliverables

- Sample .xlsx spreadsheet.
- Configured Employee Test and Employee Import tables.
- Saved Transform Map and field mappings.

- Import and transform validation evidence.
- Coalesce repeat-import test evidence.
- Three reports and one dashboard.
- Project documentation and presentation.